MEASURE O
CITY OF COLTON

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE O

This Impartial Analysis of Measure O has been prepared by the City Attorney pursuant to Section 9280 of the California Elections Code.

On March 3, 2026, the City Council placed Measure "O" on the November 3, 2026 General Municipal Election ballot. Measure "O" asks Colton voters whether the position of Colton City Treasurer should be an appointed position or remain an elected one. If Measure "O" passes, the City Treasurer would be appointed by the Colton City Council and no longer elected by Colton voters. If Colton voters approve Measure "O", the City Council will appoint the next City Treasurer when the term of the current incumbent expires in November, 2028.

Currently in Colton, an elected City Treasurer serves a four year term. The Office was last elected in November, 2024, is currently occupied by Mr. Michael Razo, and will expire in November, 2028. California law requires that general law cities, like Colton, have either an elected or appointed City Treasurer. However, a transition from an elected City Treasurer to an appointed City Treasurer must be approved by a majority of the City's voters voting at an election. If Measure "O" passes and the position becomes appointed, the City Council will decide the minimum education and training requirements for the position and periodically review the City Treasurer's performance.

A "yes" vote on Measure "O" will convert the office of Colton City Treasurer into an appointed position and no election for the City Treasurer's Office would be held in November, 2028 or future years unless and until changed again by Colton voters via another measure.

A "no" vote on Measure "O" will leave the City Treasurer as an elected office which would be placed back up for election in November, 2028.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure "O". If you desire a copy of the Measure, please call Stephanie Vargas, the City's elections official at (909) 370-5001 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

/s/ CARLOS CAMPOS
City Attorney

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE O

This Argument in Favor of Measure O was submitted pursuant to Section 9282 of the California Elections Code. It is the opinion of the author(s), and has been printed exactly as submitted.

Vote YES on Measure O to institute critical accountability provisions in the vital role of Treasurer for the City of Colton.

The City of Colton is responsible for providing vital city services that our community relies on, and it is essential that the City Treasurer is properly qualified.

Currently, the only qualification to become City Treasurer is that the officeholder be a resident of the City of Colton.

Measure O would transfer the role of City Treasurer from an elected position to an appointed position. This would ensure that the role of City Treasurer would be screened for experience, education, work ethics, and would be subject to a thorough background check.

Municipal treasury responsibilities have expanded significantly over time and have become more complicated. A City Treasurer should be a professional accountant who is qualified to perform the required duties and effectively communicate with the staff and the Council with timely and comprehensive monthly reports.

Vote YES on Measure O to:

- **Establish** professional qualifications/relevant experience requirements
- **Enhance** accountability provisions
- **Improve** continuity of operations
- **Provide** the necessary structure for true performance evaluation

Additionally, the potential election cost savings could be used to enhance our community programs such as Senior Citizen classes, summer youth sports or an enhanced childcare curriculum. Let’s make the City Treasurer’s office accountable to you, the taxpayers of Colton.

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR – Continued on next page

Measure O would not change the importance of treasury functions of financial oversight. It would simply ensure that the role is performed by a professional accountant with relevant experience in doing the job.

Vote YES on Measure O. Colton taxpayers deserve a professional and experienced City Treasurer.

s/ Dr.G (Dr. Luis S. González), Council Member and Community Advocate
s/ Aurelio De La Torre, Utility Commissioner and Past Colton City Treasurer

FULL TEXT FOR MEASURE O

ORDINANCE NO. O-19-26

AN ORDINANCE OF THE PEOPLE OF THE CITY OF COLTON, CALIFORNIA, AMENDING SECTION 2.12.020 OF CHAPTER 2.12 AND ADDING CHAPTER 2.15 (CITY TREASURER) TO TITLE 2 (ADMINISTRATION AND PERSONNEL) OF THE COLTON MUNICIPAL CODE TO CHANGE THE OFFICE OF CITY TREASURER FROM AN ELECTED OFFICE TO AN APPOINTED OFFICE.

NOW THEREFORE, THE PEOPLE OF THE CITY OF COLTON DO ORDAIN AS FOLLOWS:

SECTION 1. Subject to the approval of a majority of the voters of the City of Colton at the scheduled election so designated by the City Council in a separate resolution placing this proposal on the ballot for such election, Section 2.12.020 of Chapter 2.12 is amended and Chapter 2.15 is hereby added to Title 2 of the Colton Municipal Code and shall read as follows:

[**NOTE**: deletions are identified in ~~strikeout text~~ and additions are identified in ***bold italics***]

"**TITLE 2: ADMINISTRATION AND PERSONNEL.**

CHAPTER 2.12 - COMPENSATION OF CITY OFFICIALS - BONDS

2.12.020 - City Treasurer.

The ***appointed*** Treasurer of the City shall be paid a salary ***as set by the City Council*** ~~of four hundred and seven dollars and zero cents ($407.00) per month~~ payable at the time and in the manner that other salaries are paid. ~~The City Council may provide by Resolution for supplemental compensation.~~

. . . .

CHAPTER 2.15 – APPOINTED CITY TREASURER

2.15.010 Appointed Position.

As of the November 7, 2028 General Municipal Election, or such earlier time should a vacancy occur in the office prior to said Election, the office of the City Treasurer shall be cease to be elected and shall become an appointive office. Pursuant to California Government Code section 36510, such appointive officer shall hold office during the pleasure of the City Council and, notwithstanding Government Code section 36502 to the contrary, shall not be required to be a resident or elector in the City. The City Council may by subsequent ordinance vest in the City Manager its authority to appoint such officer."

SECTION 2. If any portion of this Ordinance is declared invalid by a court of law or other legal body with applicable authority, the invalidity shall not affect or prohibit the force and effect of any other provision or application of the Ordinance that is not deemed invalid. The voters of the City hereby declare that they would have circulated for qualification and/or voted for the adoption of this section, and each portion thereof, regardless of the fact that any portion of the initiative may be subsequently deemed invalid.

SECTION 3. To the fullest extent allowed by law, the provisions of this Ordinance shall prevail over, and supersede, all other provisions of the Municipal Code and any ordinances, resolutions or administrative policies of the City of Colton which are in conflict with any provision of this Ordinance.

SECTION 4. This section shall not be repealed or amended except by a measure approved by a majority of the electors voting on the issue at a General Municipal Election, or at a special election called for that purpose.

SECTION 5. This Ordinance shall take effect only if approved by a majority of the eligible voters of the City of Colton voting at a General Municipal Election to be held on November 3, 2026, and shall take effect ten (10) days after the City Council has certified the results of the General Municipal Election by resolution.

SECTION 6. The Mayor is hereby authorized to attest to the adoption of this Ordinance by the People voting thereon on November 3, 2026, by signing where indicated below.

FULL TEXT – Continued on next page

I hereby certify that the foregoing Ordinance was passed, approved and adopted by the People of the City of Colton on the 3rd day of November, 2026.

Dated: _____

_____
FRANK NAVARRO, MAYOR

ATTEST:

_____
ISAAC SUCHIL
CITY CLERK

APPROVED AS TO FORM:

_____
CARLOS CAMPOS
CITY ATTORNEY